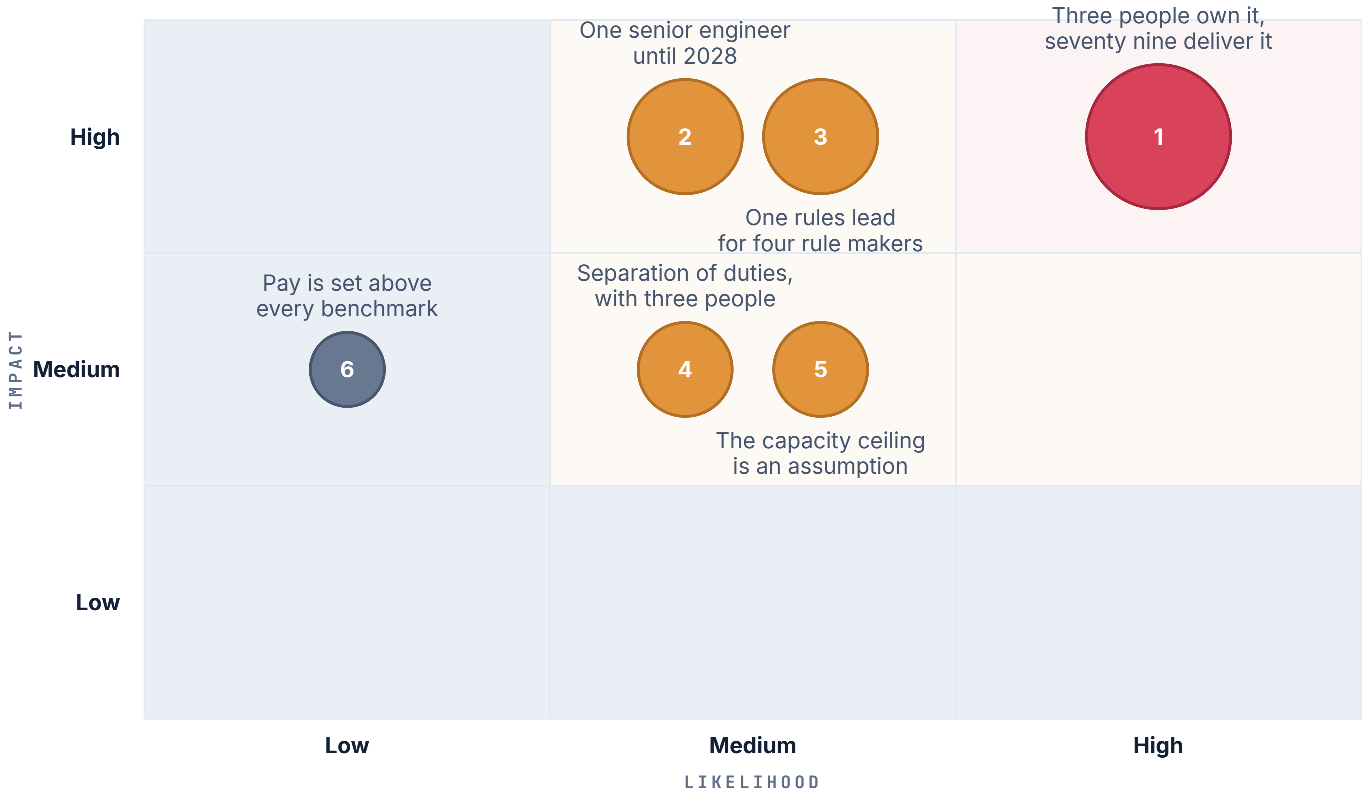
DOMAIN 06 · SIX SCENARIOS · RE-RUN QUARTERLY, AND WHEN ANY NAMED ROLE IS FILLED OR OPENS

Key-Person and Team Risk

Is a three person company that contracts most of its delivery a single point of failure, and do the rules it sets for itself survive its own headcount?

Every role in this plan is defined twice: by what it owns and by what it may not do. The rules lead authors and signs every content release and cannot deploy code. The senior engineer owns the store and the two dates and cannot author rule content. The founder sets the price and says no, and cannot approve a release alone. The customer's compliance officer signs every reconciliation and every filing, and this company never signs on their behalf. **Those separations are the product as much as the software is, because a record signed by whoever was available is not evidence.** The risk in this domain is that they are held by three people in 2026 and by forty seven in 2031, against seventy nine contracted.



Bubble size is the risk score, likelihood 1 to 3 multiplied by impact 1 to 3. The number inside is the scenario row in the table overleaf.

High 7 to 9 · Medium 4 to 6 · Low 1 to 3

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Headcount	Employees of 3, 12, 23, 32, 38 and 47 at year end across 2026 to 2031. Contracted delivery of 1.25, 10.37, 29.15, 52.25, 64.21 and 79.08 full time equivalents. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, team roadmap tab.	MODEL
What each role may not do	The permission table by component and the separation of duties list. 4orm Finance Technical Architecture 03.2, 17 August 2026 · 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, team roadmap tab, section 5.	MODEL
Scoring	Likelihood and impact are management judgements on a 1 to 3 scale.	MODEL

The six scenarios, scored

#	Scenario and trigger	L	I	Score	Early warning signal
1	**Three people own the company and seventy nine contracted people deliver it** Employees run 3, 12, 23, 32, 38 and 47 across the six years. Contracted delivery rises from 1.25 full time equivalents to 79.08. From 2028 there are more contracted people on this plan than employed ones, every year	3	3	9	Any of the four components marked senior only, inside the company, appearing in a build partner statement of work or a partner sprint plan
2	**One senior engineer carries the two layers nobody else may build, until 2028** The role runs 1, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5. It owns the store that is only added to, the two dates and the filing packs, and it is never delegated to anybody outside the company. It also may not author rule content	2	3	6	The requisition still open when the architecture note is due, or a second person needed on the evidence store before the 2028 headcount arrives
3	**One rules lead has to cover four rule makers** The role runs 1, 1, 1, 2, 3 and 4, fractional first. It authors and signs every content release, cannot deploy code and cannot approve a customer filing. The second rule maker budget buys four rule sets, not one	2	3	6	A content release shipping without a signature, or the second rule maker work starting before a second rules lead is funded
4	**Separation of duties has to hold while there are three people to hold it** The founder sets price and scope and says no, and may not author content or approve a release alone. Nobody holds a standing login to live data, the founder included, and every read is an event with a name, a time and a ticket	2	2	4	Any standing access to live data granted to anybody, or one person appearing as both preparer and approver on any release or filing
5	**The capacity ceiling that carries the ramp is an assumption** Implementation runs 4, 8, 11, 13 and 16 people against 52 live customers each by 2031, under a ceiling that rises from 30 to 75 on the assumption that setup becomes a template for each size band	2	2	4	Customers per implementation person approaching the stated ceiling in any year, or the ceiling not rising as the template work lands
6	**Pay is set above every published Canadian benchmark, on purpose** The blended loaded cost is $142,000 a person against published Canadian compliance officer figures between $66,955 and $97,000. The plan is not underpaying, which means it has no cost lever left in the team line	1	2	2	Time to fill exceeding one full quarter on any senior engineering or regulatory role during the 2027 to 2029 scale-up

Legend. Likelihood and impact each run 1 to 3 and the score is their product. Every early warning signal here is a fact about a document or a requisition rather than a judgement about a person, which is the only way this domain can be reviewed at a board table without becoming personal.

1 Three people own the company and seventy nine contracted people deliver it

SCORE 9 · L3 × I3

EVIDENCE · WHERE THE LINE BETWEEN EMPLOYED AND CONTRACTED ACTUALLY FALLS

The people plan is unusual and it is deliberate. Employees reach 47 by 2031 while contracted delivery reaches 79.08 full time equivalents, covering support, security, partner and project delivery and the outside build team. From 2028 onward there are more contracted people on this plan than employed ones in every single year. The workbook says the quiet part out loud: these are people, just not employees, and a revenue per head figure that leaves them out should not be quoted. **Four things are never handed over. The store that is only added to, the two dates, the filing packs and the rule store are built by senior hands inside the company, and each layer that carries the position stays in house so that a change of build partner is a delay rather than a loss.** Everything built belongs to 4orm Finance the day it is made.

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> The control is the permission table, and it only works if somebody reads it before each statement of work rather than after. Platform, ingest, the core, the screens and the assistant go to the build partner, with ingest and the surface reviewed before merge and no production data ever. The evidence store, the two dates, the filing packs and the rule content do not. **Check every partner scope against that table before it is signed, and treat the appearance of any of the four in a partner plan as a stop rather than a conversation.** Three supporting items, all cheap. The intellectual property assignment is signed before any deposit moves, with a list of anything the partner already owned and a written waiver of the developer's personal claim to be credited. The security review is bought outside the base from a firm with no hand in the build, because a review by the people who wrote the code is not a review. And every deliverable clears the internal architecture acceptance test before the next phase begins, which is a quality gate rather than a delivery date.

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The two populations	Employees of 3, 12, 23, 32, 38 and 47. Contracted delivery of 1.25, 10.37, 29.15, 52.25, 64.21 and 79.08 full time equivalents. Total people of 4.25 to 126.08. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, team roadmap tab, section 2.	MODEL
Who may build what	Platform, ingest, the core, the screens and the assistant: build partner. Evidence store, two dates, filing packs, rule content: ours, senior only. Security review: external specialist, never the team that built it. 4orm Finance Technical Architecture 03.2, 17 August 2026, who is permitted to build each component.	MODEL
The assignment	Milestone 3, intellectual property assignment signed, Q3 2026, before any deposit. Everything built is assigned on creation, with a list of pre-existing partner property and a written waiver of the personal claim to be credited. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, milestones tab.	MODEL
The build budget	$6,736,391 of development expense across six years on a base price of $40,000 a month rising to $45,000, plus $145,000 of security review bought outside it and $585,000 of second rule maker content. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, development expense tab.	MODEL

2 One senior engineer carries the two layers nobody else may build, until 2028

SCORE 6 · L2 × I3

EVIDENCE · ONE PERSON, TWO LAYERS, AND FOUR THINGS THAT CANNOT BE ADDED LATER

The senior engineering line runs 1, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5 across the six years, so there is a single holder of it through 2026 and 2027 and the second arrives in 2028. That role owns the store that is only added to, the two dates that say which day a record is about and which day it was written, and the filing packs. It is described as never delegated to anybody outside the company, and it is also fenced in the other direction: it may not author rule content. **Three of the four things that cannot be added to the record later sit inside that one role, and two of them are invisible in any demonstration.** The role is small by design, and the workbook is explicit that the smallness is what makes the contracted and assisted work reviewable at all.

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> Two controls, and one of them is a document rather than a hire. First, the architecture note is the transfer mechanism: it is due in Q3 2026, it gates the second open instalment, and it is tested against the four properties in the architecture pack. Written properly it moves the design out of one person's head and into a reviewable artefact, which is the only real hedge available at this headcount. **Name an explicit backup reviewer on the architecture acceptance sign-off before the next build partner phase gate, so acceptance is never a single person's signature.** Second, hold the sequencing rule rather than the calendar. If the note is due and the role is carrying more than one person's work, the honest move is to slip the milestone rather than to let a layer marked never delegated pass to whoever is available. The road has one negative month in February 2027 either way, and a slipped milestone costs less than a store that turns out not to be add only in 2029.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

The role	Senior engineer, evidence store and time model: 1, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5. Never delegated to anybody outside the company. Owns the evidence store, the two dates and the filing packs. May not author rule content. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, team roadmap tab.	MODEL
The four things	A store that is only added to, two dates on every record, rules held as writing, and customers apart at the key. Three of the four sit in this role. 4orm Finance Technical Architecture 03.2, 17 August 2026.	MODEL
The gate	Milestone 2, architecture note delivered and accepted, Q3 2026, tested against the four properties in the architecture pack, gating the second open instalment. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, milestones and capital structure tabs.	MODEL

Headcount is not the barrier in this category, and two of the assessed vendors prove it.

Kani Payments won recognition in this field on about thirty staff. Guardexia shipped a priced safeguarding product under a single founder and published an early adopter rate for its first three clients. Both are cited in the comparables as proof that a small team can take this category outright. The exposure in a small team is therefore not capacity. It is that a separation of duties designed for forty seven people has to hold when there are three, and that the two layers carrying the whole claim sit with one person until 2028.

3 One rules lead has to cover four rule makers

SCORE 6 · L2 × I3

EVIDENCE · THE SIGNATURE THE REGULATION REQUIRES SOMEBODY TO BE ABLE TO TRACE

The rules lead runs 1, 1, 1, 2, 3 and 4, starting fractional, with one per rule maker once the second is live. The role authors and signs every content release, and it cannot deploy code and cannot approve a customer filing. That fencing is not internal preference. A rule release in the evidence store carries the duty, the dates it applies to, what changed and the signature, and the reviewer who eventually reads it must not have participated in establishing, implementing or maintaining the framework under review (Justice Laws Canada). **Meanwhile the budget buys four rule sets rather than one: Alberta property management plus three Ontario cadences that do not agree with each other on when a reconciliation is due or who signs it.**

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> The exposure is that the second rule maker work is funded before the second author is. The content budget of $585,000 sits in 2027 and 2028, at $60,000 then $180,000, while the second rules lead does not arrive until 2029. Two controls. Bring the fractional engagement forward and make it dated rather than open ended, so the person who authors and signs the library has reviewed it before the second rule maker and the Q3 2028 milestone ride on it. And hold the release discipline absolutely from the first release: no content release ships without a signature, and the signature is the thing an outside reviewer will eventually pull on. **The test that proves the whole platform claim is also the test that proves this role is real: hand a new duty to the person who owns the rules, with no engineer in the room, and watch whether it goes live without a builder, a ticket or a code review.** If it cannot, the role is nominal and the second rule maker is a second product.

4 Separation of duties has to hold while there are three people to hold it

SCORE 4 · L2 × I2

EVIDENCE · FOUR QUESTIONS A BUYER'S REVIEWER ASKS, AND THE ANSWERS ALREADY WRITTEN DOWN

The separations are already stated as answers rather than as intentions. Can one customer's data be reached from another customer's session? No path exists, not in a query, not in an index, not in the assistant, and it is checked below the query rather than inside it. Does anyone at 4orm Finance hold a standing login to live data? Nobody, the founder included, and every read is an event with a name, a time and a ticket on it, including reads by this company. Where is the data? Canada, with the region named in the contract and every supplier named and disclosed with notice before any change. **The first three are answerable in a first sales call. The fourth, what happens to stored records if a key is swapped, is held pending the filing with counsel, and the document says so rather than improvising.**

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> A rule that cannot be enforced at three people will not be enforced at forty seven, so the discipline has to be built while it costs nothing. Three items. No standing access to live data for anybody, granted once and then never, because the exception granted under pressure on a support call is the named second most likely way the whole add only claim ends. One person is never both preparer and approver on any release or any filing, which the worked example of the second rule maker already encodes as a field rather than as a habit. And the customer's own compliance officer signs every reconciliation and every filing, with this company never signing on their behalf and never deciding anything for them. **That last boundary is the same sentence that answers the vendor liability question in the regulatory domain and the accountability question in the execution domain, and it should be said identically in all three places.**

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

The role	Regulatory lead, fractional then full time, 1, 1, 1, 2, 3, 4, one per rule maker once the second is live. Authors and signs every content release. Cannot deploy code and cannot approve a customer filing. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, team roadmap tab.	MODEL
Reviewer independence	The reviewer must not have participated in establishing, implementing or maintaining the framework or the safeguarding measures being reviewed. Justice Laws Canada, SOR/2023-229 · the regulations in full	PRIMARY
The four cadences	Ontario mortgage administrators file within 90 days of fiscal year end (FSRA), brokerages are reviewed monthly by the broker of record (RECO), lawyers reconcile monthly within 25 days of month end (Law Society of Ontario), and Alberta property management is a fourth.	PRIMARY
The content budget	$585,000 across four rule sets, $60,000 in 2027 and $180,000 in 2028, against a second rules lead arriving in 2029. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, development expense and team roadmap tabs.	MODEL

5 The capacity ceiling that carries the ramp is an assumption

SCORE 4 · L2 × I2

CASE STUDY · REVENUE AGAINST PEOPLE, AGAINST THE PUBLISHED BENCHMARK

The conventional test of whether delivery has been solved is recurring revenue per employee, and the published benchmark is about US$235,000 (KeyBanc Capital Markets). This plan carries 47 employees against $105,276,946 of revenue in 2031, roughly $2.2M a head. Counting the contracted delivery team brings it to 126 people and about $835,000 a head, which is still more than twice the benchmark. For scale on the other side of the transaction, total money laundering compliance cost at a mid-size bank runs from US$500,000 to more than US$3M a year, with personnel at 50 to 60 per cent of the spend (Fraxtional). The customers are not thinly staffed. The vendor is.

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> The bridge between the sales plan and the hiring plan is one row, and it is worth reading every quarter. Implementation and customer success runs 4, 8, 11, 13 and 16 people, carrying 16.25, 29.80, 42.96, 49.63 and 52.16 live customers each, under a ceiling that rises from 30 to 75. Headroom stays positive throughout and reaches 365 customers by 2031, so nothing fails on the arithmetic. **What has to be true is the ceiling itself, which rises only because setup is assumed to become a template for each size band, and the workbook is explicit that this is a limit rather than a proof.** Two controls, both already named elsewhere in the bundle and both belonging here too. Measure days to first value from customer one rather than customer twenty, and publish it monthly, because the ceiling is a restatement of that number. And review actual load against the stated ceiling at each customer milestone, treating any year where load approaches the ceiling as a hiring decision taken in advance rather than a shortfall discovered in delivery.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

The four answers	Tenant isolation checked below the query, no standing login to live data for anybody including the founder, every read an event with a name a time and a ticket, and data in Canada with the region named in the contract. The key swap answer is held pending the filing. 4orm Finance Technical Architecture 03.2, 17 August 2026, keeping customers apart and where the data lives.	MODEL
Delivery capacity	Implementation of 4, 8, 11, 13 and 16 people against loads of 16.25 to 52.16 and a ceiling rising 30 to 75, with headroom of 55 to 365. Stated as a limit rather than a proof. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, team roadmap tab, section 4.	MODEL
Benchmarks	KeyBanc Capital Markets, about US$235,000 of recurring revenue a head · Fraxtional, money laundering compliance cost at a mid-size bank	SECONDARY

6 Pay is set above every published Canadian benchmark, on purpose

SCORE 2 · L1 × I2

CASE STUDY · WHAT A COMPLIANCE OFFICER IS PAID IN CANADA, FROM THREE SOURCES

Published Canadian figures for the nearest comparable role cluster well below what this plan carries. PayScale puts the average base salary at C$66,955 (PayScale). Talent.com reports $97,000, with an entry figure of $83,300 (Talent.com). Indeed reports an average of $71,866 across 633 reported salaries (Indeed). The plan uses a blended loaded cost of $142,000 a person, rising 3 per cent a year, plus benefits and payroll taxes on top. **It is not underpaying, and that is the finding rather than the complaint.**

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> Two consequences follow and both are worth saying in a room. The first is that there is no cost lever left in the team line. A plan already paying above the published market cannot absorb a slipped milestone by paying less, which is why the discretionary cut list in the funding domain names everything except the four gating milestones and not the people. The second is that pay is not the reason a role stays open. Net new heads run 3, 9, 11, 9, 6 and 9, with engineering going from 1 to 11 across the plan, and the two roles that gate everything are also the two hardest to hire in Canada for regulated payments work. **The control is time to fill rather than compensation: any senior engineering or regulatory requisition open longer than one full quarter during the 2027 to 2029 scale-up is an escalation, and it is escalated because the milestone chain assumes those quarters are free.** Review headcount and time to fill against plan at each customer milestone, at the same cadence as the milestones themselves, rather than treating hiring as a function that follows revenue.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Small teams in this field	Kani Payments at about thirty staff with two industry awards. Guardexia, a single founder, a published price list and an early adopter rate for the first three clients. 4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026, section 6. Kani Payments · Guardexia pricing	PRIMARY
The four gates that carry the plan	Milestones 2, 3, 4 and 5: architecture note accepted, intellectual property assignment signed, twenty discovery calls done, two design partners engaged. All four fall in 2026 and none is expensive. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, milestones tab.	MODEL
Hiring shape	Net new heads of 3, 9, 11, 9, 6 and 9. Engineering rising from 1 to 11, which is the base the research credit is calculated on. Blended loaded cost of $142,000 a person rising 3 per cent a year, plus benefits and payroll taxes at about 18 per cent of pay. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, team roadmap tab.	MODEL
The customer's own signature	The customer's compliance officer signs every reconciliation and every filing. This company never signs on a customer's behalf and never decides anything for them, and the duty stays with the firm holding the money. Bank of Canada safeguarding guideline · 4orm Finance Technology Overview 03.1, 17 August 2026.	PRIMARY

What to watch, and how often

Two of these lines are about documents, three are about rules that cost nothing to keep and everything to reinstate, and two are about time to fill. None of them is about a person, which is the only way this domain can be reviewed without becoming a conversation about individuals.

Monitoring cadence

- **Every build partner scope, before it is signed.** Against the permission table. The store that is only added to, the two dates, the filing packs and the rule content appearing in a partner plan is a stop rather than a conversation.
- **The architecture note, and a named backup reviewer on its sign-off.** Before the next build partner phase gate, so acceptance of the design is never one person's signature.
- **The fractional rules lead, dated rather than open ended.** The content budget lands in 2027 and 2028 and the second author arrives in 2029. Bring the engagement forward and put a date on it.
- **Standing access to live data, continuously.** Nobody, the founder included. The exception granted under pressure on a support call is the named second most likely way the add only claim ends.
- **Preparer against approver, on every release and every filing.** Never the same person. The worked example already encodes it as a field, which means it can be tested rather than trusted.
- **Customers per implementation person against the stated ceiling, quarterly.** Load approaching the ceiling in any year is a hiring decision taken in advance, not a shortfall discovered in delivery.
- **Time to fill on senior engineering and regulatory roles, at every customer milestone.** Longer than one full quarter during the 2027 to 2029 scale-up is an escalation, because the milestone chain assumes those quarters are free.

The separations are the product, not the policy.

A record signed by whoever was available is not evidence, and a rule release with nobody's name on it cannot be traced by the outside reviewer the regulation requires. Every role in this plan is defined by what it may not do as much as by what it owns, and at three people those limits cost almost nothing to keep. At forty seven, with seventy nine contracted people beside them, they cost a great deal to put back.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

The separations	The permission table by component, and the role list stating what each role owns and may not do. 4orm Finance Technical Architecture 03.2, 17 August 2026 · 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, team roadmap tab, section 5.	MODEL
Pay	Blended loaded cost of $142,000 a person, rising 3 per cent a year, plus benefits and payroll taxes. Against PayScale · Talent.com · Indeed.	MODEL / TERTIARY
Every figure on this document	4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full. 4orm Finance Master Source Register, 16 August 2026.	MODEL